

Day 2 — Two Fortnights — Pakṣa

Module: Moon Phases and Tithi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: distinguish śukla pakṣa from kṛṣṇa pakṣa and name today's.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *pakṣa* (IAST: pakṣa; lit. “fortnight (half-month)”)

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Define pakṣa.** A *pakṣa* is a half-month: 14–16 days. Two per synodic month.
 - *śukla pakṣa* (waxing fortnight) — *amāvasyā* → *pūrṇimā* — moon growing.
 - *kṛṣṇa pakṣa* (waning fortnight) — *pūrṇimā* → *amāvasyā* — moon shrinking.
2. **Etymology.** *śukla* = bright; *kṛṣṇa* = dark. *Pakṣa* = side / wing — same root as *pakṣapāta* (taking sides).
3. **Source.** Sūrya-siddhānta and the *Pañca-siddhāntikā* of Varāhamihira both organise lunar tables by pakṣa.
4. **Identify today’s pakṣa.** Pull up the current pañcāṅga (web or printed). “*Which pakṣa are we in right now? Which tithi?*” Students record the date AND the pakṣa name in their workbook.
5. **Cultural note.** Many traditional Indian festivals are named by tithi within pakṣa (e.g. *Karka Saṅkrānti tritīyā*, *Karwa Chauth* = *Kṛṣṇa caturthī* of Kārtika). Pakṣa labelling is more precise than “the third of Kārtika.”

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *10-Day Moon Observation Diary* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces Two Fortnights — Pakṣa.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).